

HERE'S A TIP
Ohio State's George Reese tries for a basket during the Buckeyes' 64-61 win over Illinois. D2



COLLEGE BASKETBALL

Rollie shakes things up; Vikings snap skid. D2

H.S. WRESTLING

Keystone takes 2nd at Firelands Invite. D6

GOLF

Mediate widens lead over Tiger at Phoenix. D9

Sports

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DAN COUGHLIN

Early Wynn: Tough guy, Tribe hero

Steve Jankowski was feeling mighty blue the other day when he heard reports of Early Wynn's failing health.

The Hall of Fame pitcher, who turned 70 earlier this month, was a mainstay of the Indians' Big Four pitching staff of the 1960s. He won 20 games four times for Cleveland, and his victory totals were in the high teens almost every other year.

After the Indians traded him to Chicago, he won 24 for the White Sox and helped them win the pennant in 1959. He came back to Cleveland to win his 300th game in 1963.

Jankowski, a middle infielder who came out of South High, never made the majors, but he came close. He spent 10 years in the Tribe's farm system, many of them at Triple A, when another hit or two in spring training would have catapulted him onto the big-league roster when camp broke.

"But I came so close to those guys," said Jankowski, who lives in the suburb of Seven Hills. "I knew them, guys like Early Wynn, Bob Lemon, Bob Feller."

At a time like this, it would be appropriate to refute some old myths about Wynn.

For example, we asked Jankowski if Wynn really would throw at his grandmother.

"I don't think so, because when I knew him I think his grandmother was dead," said Jankowski. "But his mother was another story."

Jankowski recalls a warm April morning in Tucson when Wynn, suffering from back problems, was trying to work himself back into shape by throwing batting practice to the Triple-A players.

"I stepped into the batter's box and on the first pitch I hit a bullet back to the mound," Jankowski said. "It went right through Wynn's legs. In those days, they didn't have the screen in front of the pitcher during batting practice."

"I knew what was coming next, so I started to walk away. Wynn called to me. 'Hey, get back in there,' he said."

"That's OK. I'm loose," I said. "Don't worry. I'm not going to throw at you," Wynn said.

"So I put a batting helmet on and got back in the box. On the very next pitch, he threw a fast-ball right at my head."

As Jankowski describes it, his helmet and bat were still in the air when he hit the dirt.

"It was like one of those Bugs Bunny cartoons where suddenly all you see are the helmet and the bat," said Jankowski.

"Wynn walked halfway to the plate and he said, 'Don't you ever hit a ball up the middle at me.' Then he turned around and started walking back to the

See COUGHLIN, D5



SUPER COACH: Atlanta's Dan Reeves, who had heart bypass surgery in December, instructs his team during a walk-through Saturday at Pro Player Stadium.

Plots aplenty

Feud, Elway, surgery take center stage

Leonard Shapiro
The Washington Post

MIAMI — It is not quite the Super Bowl matchup anyone would have imagined when players began sweating and straining at training camps across America last July. Even Atlanta Falcons coach Dan Reeves admitted the other day that he had no pretensions about turning a 7-9 team into one on the brink of its first world championship.

Nevertheless, the Falcons are making no apologies for their first Super Bowl appearance in their 33-year history today at Pro Player Stadium against the defending champion Denver

SUPER BOWL XXXIII
WHO: Denver Broncos (16-2) vs. Atlanta Falcons (16-2)
TIME: Kickoff is at 6:25 p.m.
WHERE: Pro Player Stadium, between Miami and Fort Lauderdale, Fla.
TV/RADIO: Channel 5 and WFLX 930-AM. Program on Channel 8 starts at 11 a.m.
ODDS: The Broncos are 7 1/2-point favorites.

Broncos in a game likely to be watched by more than 800 million around the world.

Both teams are 16-2 and come into this matchup with intriguing

story lines and plot twists, not the least of which involves the still simmering bad feelings between Reeves and Denver coach Mike Shanahan, a one-time Broncos offensive coordinator fired by Reeves in 1991 for insubordination. Adding to the storybook angle: A little more than one month ago, on Dec. 14, Reeves had heart bypass surgery. "Regardless of who is the head coach on the other team, it wouldn't matter," Shanahan said this week. "This is an opportunity that comes around once in a lifetime."

Said Reeves, fired by the Bron-

See SUPER BOWL, D9

HIGH SCHOOL BASKETBALL

Falls rocks River

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

ROCKY RIVER — Some refer to it simply as the Falls River war.

No doubt about that.

Put Olmsted Falls and Rocky River on the basketball floor, and you're bound to get a great, intense struggle — one with Southwestern Conference championship implications.

Saturday, the Bulldogs staved off a furious Rocky River rally in the second half to win 55-48.

Falls (10-2, 8-1 in the SWC) took a giant step toward its fourth straight SWC title. Falls and River tied for the crown a year ago, but this year the Pirates (9-5, 6-4 SWC) find themselves trailing by 2 1/2 games.

"They don't quit," said Falls coach Pat Donahue of River's comeback. "Jim (Rock) does a great job coaching that team, and they do a great job executing what they're trying to do. Our main goal was to try and disrupt their offense."

Falls seemingly took control with a five-point burst in the final five seconds of the first half that sent the teams to intermission with the Bulldogs on top 36-23.

The Bulldogs worked the ball down to precious few ticks when Manzie Williams hit a 3-pointer from the right baseline.

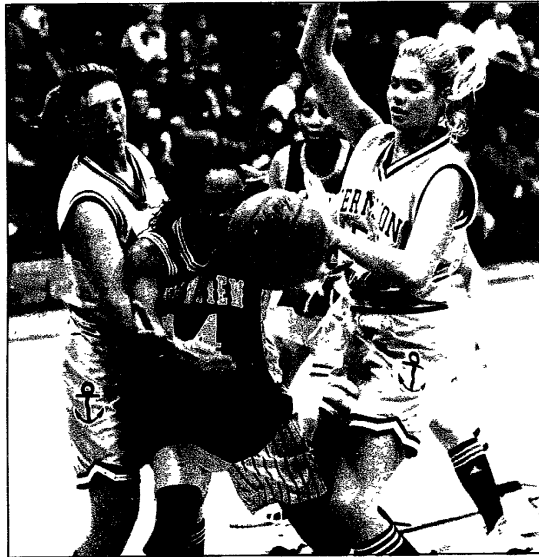
Joe Stanton then swiped the inbound pass and quickly put it up to beat the buzzer, pushing Falls' lead from eight to 13 points in a snap of the fingers.

"The three was something we set up," said Donahue. "That's a play we run at the end

of the game."

Vermilion, ranked 15th in Division II, spotted Clearview

See FALLS, D6



STEVE MANHEIM / CHRONICLE

HARD TO HANDLE: Clearview's Layla Willis (middle) battles for the ball with Vermilion's Melissa Fieglert (left) and Liz Haynes during the Sailors' 51-46 win.

Sailors right ship, beat Clippers

Bob Daniels
The Chronicle-Telegram

VERMILION — In a game that matched two of the area's best teams, swing players and point guards, twice-beaten Vermilion knocked off once-beaten Clearview 51-46 Saturday in a quality girls basketball game.

Vermilion, ranked 15th in Division II, spotted Clearview

the first eight points, then got off the floor to win for the 18th time in 15 games.

Clearview, ranked second in Division III, dropped to 14-2. The Clippers' only other loss was to Margaretta, sixth-ranked in Division III and a perennial tournament power.

"That was a wild one," said Vermilion coach Skip Davis. "Once we got into the flow and

settled down, I felt we were in control the rest of the way."

"We had too many unforced mistakes," Clearview coach Jim Horvath said. "You can't play a team like Vermilion, continually shoot yourself in the foot with unforced mistakes and expect to win."

See SAILORS, D9

Ozzie headed to Hall

From wire reports

MIAMI — In the same year that the Cleveland Browns return to the NFL, one of the franchise's greatest players will enter the Pro Football Hall of Fame.

Ozzie Newsome, a hybrid tight end who helped redefine the position in the 1980s with the Browns, was voted into the Hall Saturday.

Newsome will be enshrined on Aug. 7 in Canton along with Lawrence Taylor, a linebacker who made pass rushing the defensive rage, and Eric Dickerson, a running back who raised the NFL's yardage bar to record heights.

Also chosen in the Class of 1999 were two players who labored in the anonymity of the offensive line — guards Tom Mack of the Los Angeles Rams and Billy Shaw of the Buffalo Bills.

Taylor not only was the most dominant player in the group as an outside linebacker for the New York Giants, but the most controversial selection because of his legal difficulties off the field.

His success chasing down quarterbacks changed defensive strategies and linebacker profiles.

Newsome's success as a pass catcher at a position known more at the time for blocking also had widespread repercussions.

When the Browns made Newsome a first-round draft pick in 1978, he was an All-American wide receiver at Alabama who did more blocking than catching.

He became a tight end after one mini-camp under Coach Sam Rutigliano.

But by the time his 13-year

See HALL, D9

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